and denial of asylum to refugees. Considering this is a chance to break down distinctions between the way such discourses operate in the place of the self and the Other. Otherwise, to reprise Jean Baudrillard, refusal becomes part of the violence itself.[27]

Notes

1 St Antony's college is home to the Programme in Modern Burmese Studies; MIDO is a leading ICT4D (Information and Communication Technology for Development) organization in Myanmar, founded by a group of activist bloggers, 'techies,' and former political prisoner Nay Phone Latt. The M.MAS project, supported by a grant from the National Endowment for Democracy (NED), organized research and a training programme for youth activists, focused on social science research skills and theoretical approaches to understanding violence.

2 I continue to have reservations about referring to violence in Myanmar as 'communal'. However, in this chapter, I will take the approach of Gyanendra Pandey (1998, p. xiv) and use the term because its vagueness can be helpful: violence in Myanmar has been 'communal' in that it has targeted groups defined as a 'communal' Other, but I am seeking to avoid presumptions about the nature of boundaries drawn between self and Other and instead use empirical material to understand how they are being drawn.

3 For a complete analysis of the findings discussed in this chapter, see Schissler, Walton and Phyu Phyu Thi (2015). Additionally, reflections on observations from this research have been the basis for essays kindly published by the blog *New Mandala*. See <http://asiapacific.anu.edu.au/newmandala/author/matt/>.

4 This analysis also benefits from collaboration with members of M.MAS partner MIDO, whom the author wishes to thank for their insights and support.

5 The author wishes to thank Matthew J. Walton and Phyu Phyu Thi, co-conveners of the project.

6 Because the project was motivated by a desire to understand how people might, explicitly or implicitly, justify violence, research was focused on areas that have experienced violence: Sittwe, Meiktila, Lashio, and Mandalay. However, inspired by the work of Ashutosh Varshney (2003), the project also sought to include perspectives from at least two areas that have not experienced violence: Mawlamyine and Pathein. Mawlamyine was selected because it is the putative location from which the '969' movement was launched. As the capital of Mon State, including it also meant that the project could maintain a research focus that was equally balanced between ethnic states and majority Burman regions. Pathein was selected as the sixth city because the delta is generally excluded